

Qroo Paul's Spanish Master Cours

Lesson 1 Summary Sheet

AL Cognate Trick

Many English words ending in "AL" have the same form in Spanish. These are known as cognates.

Animal, legal, social, criminal, digital, final, formal, individual, normal, hospital, judicial, brutal, fundamental, general, monumental, natural, principal, rural, sentimental, total, universal, vocal.

Spanish Pronunciation Guidelines

Vowels

Spanish has 5 vowel sounds:

A: as in "animal" – like the 'a' in "father".

E: as in "central" – like the 'e' in "met".

I: as in "digital" – like the 'ee' in "see".

O: as in "hospital" – like the 'o' in "note".

U: as in "musical" – like the 'oo' in "food".

Key Consonant Pronunciations:

C: Hard sound (like K): Capital, Musical

Soft sound (like S) before E or I: Central (Latin America: 's', Spain: 'th')

G: Hard sound (like in "gone"): Global, Gradual

Soft sound (like H) before E or I: Digital, General

Y: Can be Y or J through most areas. In the Southern Cone (e.g. Argentina) it will be pronounced SH

LL: Pronounced like Y: ¿Cómo te llamas?

Z: Like 's' in Latin America and 'th' in Spain

H: Silent: Hospital

J: Like English H: Justificación

Ñ: Like 'n' in "onion": Mañana (tomorrow)

Q: Like K, always followed by silent U: Qué

B and V: Both sound like a soft B: El vino (wine)

Pronunciation of R and RR:

Single R:

At the beginning of a word: Strong trill, e.g., Rosa ['ro.sa]

Between vowels: Light tap, e.g., Caro ['ka.ro]

Elsewhere: Single tap, e.g., Alrededor [al.re.de'ðor]

Double RR:

Anywhere in a word: Strong, vibrant trill, e.g., Perro ['pe.rro]

Stress Rules in Spanish:

Words ending in a vowel, N, or S: Stress the next-to-last syllable.

Examples: Camisas (shirts), Pelo (hair), Anillo (ring), Perro (dog), Edificio (building)

Words ending in other letters: Stress the last syllable.

Examples: Bailar (to dance), Hospital (hospital), Legal (legal), Verdad (truth)

Accent Marks: Stress the syllable with the accent mark.

Examples: Justificación, Pájaros